

Token Action Card

Habits (in order of impact)

1. **Close threads the second a task is done.** */close* or */diary*. Don't keep them open "for later."
2. **One task = one thread.** New question = new chat. Cheap to bootstrap, expensive to keep alive.
3. **If a thread crosses ~50K tokens, split it.** Save state, start fresh.
4. **Don't @-mention whole files.** Mention the function. Better yet, let the agent grep.
5. **Never enable Max Mode.** (You're already not — keep it that way.)
6. **Skills > re-explaining.** Every "let me tell you again how X works" is a skill candidate.

Red flags to catch yourself on

- "I'll just keep this thread open while I work on the other thing" → no, close it.
- "Let me @-mention these 8 files for context" → pick 1.
- "I'll use thinking mode just to be safe" → no, use it when you're actually stuck.
- "It's a tiny edit, model choice doesn't matter" → on a 200K-token thread, the model rereads all 200K. It matters.

The one rule

92.7% of your tokens are cache-reads — the model re-reading the same thread over and over. Short threads + small contexts + cheap models = the whole strategy.

Pick the model on purpose

If the task is...	Use	Don't use
Read / format / grep / move files	gemini-2.5-flash	Opus anything
Cherry-pick, mechanical commits, PR descriptions, RIL/KIL drafting	composer-2.5	Opus thinking
Doc edits (DITA tags, XML tweaks)	composer-2.5	Opus thinking
Multi-file refactor, debug, "figure out why X"	claude-4.6-opus-high (no thinking)	Opus thinking
Genuinely stuck on a hard reasoning problem	opus-thinking-xhigh	—

Free stuff (per GHCP docs — Cursor likely same)

- Inline tab-completion / next-edit suggestions are **not** billed.
- Type a comment, let autocomplete finish the line — costs nothing.

When Cursor flips to UBP — playbook

- First day: do **not** use Opus until you've checked the budget meter.
- Default to **claude-4.6-opus-high** for the morning routine (standup, recap, ticket fetches).
- Reserve one "Opus session" per day for the actual hard work.
- Watch for the additional-funds portal announcement.